

Through this lesson, Cathy became a knowledgeable home record keeper. She now helps to teach other women how to manage their home accounts.

I've counseled enough to know the simplest economic principle ever written is, "If you don't overspend, you won't get in debt." And I have never counseled a couple that purposely set out to get themselves into debt. They usually let their record keeping get so bad that they had no idea where they were financially. Then they would call and say, "We've got a disaster. The creditors are going to repossess our car or our home or our child," or whatever their particular disaster was.

As you probably know, it's a lot of fun to get into debt, but it's not nearly as much fun to get out of debt. Learn what you need to know and use that information to avoid financial problems.

5 HOW GOD USES MONEY IN A MARRIAGE

As I said earlier, God uses money in a Christian marriage to show us our strengths and weaknesses and to teach us to more fully depend on Him.

A TEST OF FAITHFULNESS

One way God uses money is to test our faithfulness. Remember, the way we handle money is an outside expression of what's going on in our lives spiritually. The way we respond to financial problems is a good indicator of whether we trust God, or whether we just say we trust God. In other words, when the pressure's on, will we still do it God's way?

John and Paula had been married about five years when I met them. They were both Christians, members of a sound denominational church, and faithful in their giving to God's work. They had wanted to have children soon after their marriage and always budgeted based on John's income so that Paula could stay home when they had their first child.

Paula had gotten pregnant twice, but miscarried both times.